

Reflection Report: Missed PDP Goal

In my Personal Development Plan (PDP) for this semester, I set three main goals to help me grow my IT skills and my professional network. While I successfully finished my goals for learning the Vue.js framework and growing my LinkedIn network to over 100 connections, I did not complete my second goal. This report explains why I missed my goal to complete an introductory Artificial Intelligence (AI) course and how I spent that time learning a different skill that became much more valuable to me.

During the 4th period, on the theory module we had app development. When I started learning how to build mobile applications, particularly using Android Studio and Kotlin language, I realized how much I truly enjoyed it. Building apps felt very hands-on and creative. I loved being able to write code and immediately see a working application on a phone screen that is the main reason that I'm more of a front-end developer. This was a big turning point for me. I found myself wanting to spend all my extra free time learning more about mobile app development instead of starting the AI course. The app development course captured my interest in a way I had not expected.

Another major reason for this change was my group project. We were building an application called SoundSafe, an Android app designed to automatically adjust a phone's volume based on the noise levels around it. To make this project successful, I needed to dive deep into Android app development and UI/UX design.

By choosing to focus my extra study time on app development instead of AI, I was able to help my team build a much better product. Actually, we have a functional app with a perfect UI. I spent a lot of time working on the app's design, like the speedometer-style noise arc, and making sure the code was ready for a real release. The AI course would not have helped me with this project, but learning app development was exactly what the team needed from me.

Personal and Professional Value

Even though I missed my goal to learn AI, the choice to focus on app development was the right one for me at this time. It satisfied my needs for the project perfectly, and it also gave me a new skill that I am very passionate about. Knowing how to build Android apps is a great, highly demanded skill for my future career and will absolutely help me stand out for internships, which was the original purpose of the AI goal anyway.

Conclusion

In the future, I still want to look into AI and automation because it is an important field. However, for this semester, putting all my energy into the app development course and the SoundSafe project was the best decision. I am proud of the mobile app my team and I built, and I feel confident in my new skills. This experience taught me that while having a plan is good, being flexible and following a new path when it brings more value to my current work is even better.